

Do marketing and alcohol treatment/public health experts think televised alcohol advertisements abide by regulatory guidelines?

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Journal of Health Psychology
1–12

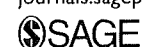
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DOI: 10.1177/1359105318770727

journals.sagepub.com/home/hpq



Abstract

Televised alcohol advertisements in the United Kingdom must abide by the Broadcast Committee of Advertising Practice Code, which provides guidelines concerning advertisements not implying, condoning or encouraging immoderate, irresponsible or antisocial drinking. Previously, 75 per cent of 373 general public respondents were shown one of seven advertisements rated a breach of at least one guideline. This study assessed whether experts in marketing ($n=25$) and alcohol treatment/public health ($n=25$) perceived the same seven television alcohol advertisements as complying with the Broadcast Committee of Advertising Practice Code. Overall, 83 per cent of advertisements were rated as breaching at least one guideline. This provides further proof that self-regulatory alcohol guidelines are not fit for purpose.

Keywords

advertising, alcohol, drinking behaviour, health promotion, public health psychology

Introduction

Worldwide, alcohol accounts for over 3 million premature deaths per year and increases risk of over 200 diseases as well as the harms due to alcohol dependence (World Health Organization (WHO), 2014). A link has been suggested between alcohol advertisements and an increase in alcohol consumption, with one meta-analysis finding that there was a small but positive association between the amount of advertising and alcohol consumption in adult populations

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(Gallet, 2007). A recent review by Jernigan et al. (2017) found a similar association in young people, concluding that there is a relationship between exposure to alcohol marketing and later alcohol consumption, with higher exposure linked to engaging in more binge and hazardous drinking behaviour.

Self-regulatory guidelines, which the media and advertising industry has voluntarily established and paid for, have been developed for alcohol advertisements in many countries in order to minimise the harmful effects of alcohol consumption. For example, in the United Kingdom, self-regulatory guidelines are co-regulated by the Advertising Standards Authority (ASA) and Ofcom, who oversee marketing communications and administer guidelines governing the advertisements. The Broadcast Committee of Advertising Practice (BCAP) consists of representatives from advertisers, broadcasters and media owners and is responsible for writing and maintaining the broadcast guidelines.

The main principle outlined in the BCAP Code is that 'Advertisements for alcoholic drinks should not be targeted at people under 18 years of age and should not imply, condone or encourage immoderate, irresponsible or antisocial drinking'. (Broadcast Committee of Advertising Practice, 2010: 92). See Table 4 for a list of the 15 BCAP Code guidelines that specifically relate to television alcohol advertisement.

In the first peer-reviewed study in the United Kingdom, to examine the success of the BCAP Code, 373 members of the general public were shown one of seven alcohol television advertisements (Searle et al., 2014). They then rated their agreement with a set of statements that were based on the text contained in the BCAP Code. This research found that 75 per cent of the general public rated the alcohol advertisements they viewed as breaching at least one BCAP Code guideline. Furthermore, some of the BCAP Code guidelines were perceived to be breached more than others. Over half the participants agreed that there was a breach of guideline 19.3, which prohibits advertisements from implying that alcohol can contribute to popularity, while only 1 per cent of the

participants rated a breach of guideline 19.9, which prohibits advertisements from linking alcohol to illicit drugs.

A potential limitation of the UK study of the BCAP Code study concerns the validity of the questionnaire, which was created specifically for that study (Searle et al., 2014). The questionnaire used text taken directly from the BCAP Code, and the format was based on a scale previously devised (Babor et al., 2008). This scale was previously devised to assess violations in the US Beer Code, the self-regulatory guidelines in place in the United States. As the UK questionnaire had not been formally validated, the authors suggested that subsequent research could compare the general public sample ratings to those of various 'experts' in the areas of public health or advertisement (Searle et al., 2014). If the pattern of breaches derived from expert ratings is found to be similar to the general public, then this will support the validity of the UK questionnaire and findings.

Previous studies in other countries have assessed the views of expert samples regarding the self-regulatory guidelines for alcohol advertisements. In the United States, 15 public health professionals rated between 35 per cent and 74 per cent of 289 alcohol advertisements as being in violation of the US Beer Code (Babor et al., 2013b). An additional study by the same team compared the results of experts across the areas of health and marketing with the ratings of members from vulnerable groups (Babor et al., 2013a). They found that both groups perceived a high number of breaches across the six alcohol advertisements, with the experts rating a mean number of 17.8 violations per advertisement and the community sample rating significantly higher at 20.5 violations per advertisement.

The main aim of this study was therefore to compare ratings from two expert samples with the general public sample previously obtained by Searle et al. (2014) in terms of breaches of the BCAP Code for seven alcohol advertisements. The expert groups in this study were professionals working in the fields of (a) marketing and (b) alcohol treatment/public health. In addition, two possible sources of variation in

the expert raters' judgement of BCAP Code compliance were examined.

First, it was hypothesised that those who work in alcohol treatment/public health would be more likely to rate a BCAP guideline breach than those who work in marketing, due to differences in their professional identity (Turner and Oakes, 1986). Those who work in alcohol treatment/public health may be more motivated to protect the public by a stricter adherence to the Code, as this approach is more congruent with their professional identity, whereas those who work in marketing may identify more with the advertising industry.

The second potential source of variation in ratings was how appealing participants rated the advertisements. There is evidence that perceiving an advertisement as appealing can lead to a more positive attitude towards the brand that it represents (MacKenzie et al., 1986; Mitchell, 1986). It was therefore hypothesised that individuals who found the advertisement more appealing would rate fewer BCAP Code breaches.

Methods

Participants

There were 50 participants overall, with 25 marketing experts and 25 alcohol treatment/public health experts. All the participants worked at universities, local authorities or public health groups in North West England, were over the age of 18 years and were competent English speakers. As previously reported, the participants from the study by Searle et al. (2014) were 373 adult volunteers representative of the general public recruited from a major train station in North West England.

Design

This study had a two group within-subjects Latin square design, with repeated alcohol advertisements shown in a counter-balanced order. See Appendix 1 for further information on the Latin square design used to counterbalance

the advertisements. The main comparison used a between-subjects design, which assessed the association between the overall ratings of BCAP Code breaches by the expert sample and the Searle et al. (2014) general public sample.

Procedure

Participants were recruited using a snowball sampling method, whereby one focal person from each of the expert groups contacted potential participants who were experts in public health, alcohol treatment or marketing. The potential participants were given the participant information sheet and asked to contact the researchers if they wanted to take part.

The participants who agreed to take part were visited at their place of work and were shown each of the seven advertisements on a portable computer. After each advertisement, they completed a questionnaire assessing compliance with the BCAP Code and ratings of appeal of advertisements. When the participants had viewed all seven advertisements, they were asked to complete a final questionnaire assessing alcohol consumption, professional experience and demographic information.

The two expert groups in this study and the general public sample from the Searle et al. (2014) study were shown the same seven alcohol television advertisements and were given the same questionnaire to complete, which assessed BCAP Code guideline compliance. The main difference between the two studies is the sample and number of advertisements viewed by each individual. The Searle et al. (2014) study had 373 members of the general public who each watched one advertisement, yielding 373 assessments. In contrast, this study uses 50 experts who each watched all seven advertisements, yielding 350 assessments.

Materials

The same seven alcohol advertisements that were used previously in the Searle et al. (2014) study were sampled from the UK channels ITV1 and Channel 4 in February 2013. See

below for a description of the seven advertisements used in the study.

1. Captain Morgan's Spiced, which features four men being served 'Captain and Colas' at a bar, while different women are shown discovering large human-shaped objects in place of the men.
2. Cobra Beer, which depicts a man walking down a busy train in India serving Cobra Beer to the young passengers.
3. Disaronno Originale, where a voiceover describes the recipe for 'Disaronno cocktail number 59' while the ingredients are shown on screen.
4. Foster's Lager, which is set in 1888 in Melbourne where the townspeople watch and cheer as the mayor drinks a pint of Foster's Lager.
5. Guinness, which shows a male cobbler bored at work, where time is reversed and a house is prevented from burning down and then time is slowed down as a group of soldiers are reunited with the townspeople.
6. Kronenbourg 1664, which features ex-footballer Eric Cantona explaining how 'the hop farmers are treated like the footballers of Britain', with several middle-aged farmers being pampered by the townspeople.
7. Strongbow Pear, which depicts a man standing alone in the desert and shooting an arrow through a pear.

After the participants viewed each advertisement, they completed a questionnaire that consisted of 36 items measuring whether the participants perceived the advertisements as breaching the BCAP Code guidelines. The questions were an amended version of the Babor et al. (2008) questionnaire, used previously by Searle et al. (2014). The 36 item questionnaire assessed the BCAP Code and covered 15 out of the 17 guidelines, as two were excluded from the original questionnaire (Searle et al., 2014). Rule 19.15.2 was excluded, as it was deemed unsuitable for adult participants to assess which

characters' examples in the advertisements were likely to be followed by, or had a strong appeal to, those under 18 years of age. Rule 19.11, which states advertisements may include sale promotions provided that they do not imply, condone or encourage immoderate drinking, was deemed to be characterised adequately by rule 19.2, which states that an advertisement must not feature, imply, condone or encourage irresponsible or immoderate drinking (see Table 4). The questions had a 5-point rating scale ranging from 'strongly agree' to 'strongly disagree' with regards to statements about the BCAP Code.

Participants were also asked five questions on the appeal of each advertisement, which were adapted from a study by Chen et al. (2005). The questions related to aspects of the advertisement the participant may have found appealing, such as the characters, the music, the humour, the story and in general how much they liked the advertisement. The questions were answered on a 5-point rating scale ranging from 'dislike a lot' to 'like a lot', with an additional option of 'does not apply'.

The second questionnaire asked four questions about professional experience developed specifically for this study and demographic questions regarding sex, age and ethnicity, which were adapted from the 2011 Census Household Questionnaire (Office for National Statistics, 2013).

Analysis

Responses to the BCAP Code questionnaire were dichotomised. The options 'strongly agree' and 'agree' were coded to indicate a breach of a guideline, while 'neither agree nor disagree', 'disagree' and 'strongly disagree' indicated compliance with a guideline. The overall frequency of breaches was calculated for each group of participants across the different advertisements and across the BCAP Code guidelines, with a one-sample *t*-test used to analyse whether the results were significantly different from zero. A Spearman's rank correlation was used to measure the agreement across advertisements between the different groups and across

guidelines between the different groups. The groups were the general public, all experts, the marketing experts and the alcohol treatment/public health experts.

To assess the advertisements' appeal, an average rating was calculated from the five questions for each advertisement, with imputation for up to two missing or not applicable items. A Spearman's rank correlation was also used to examine if the appeal ratings for each of the advertisements influenced their judgement of breaches in the BCAP Code.

A Wilcoxon signed-rank test was used to assess whether there were differences in mean numbers of breaches across the seven advertisements, between different groups of raters.

Results

The majority of the sample was White British, between the ages of 30–59 years, with nearly 50 per cent of the sample having more than 10 years' work experience in their respective field. See Table 1 for the full demographic information of the sample and Table 2 for information on the participants' typical alcohol consumption.

The Captain Morgan's Spiced advertisement was rated as breaching at least one BCAP Code guideline by the highest proportion of expert participants (94%). The Disaronno advertisement was rated by the lowest proportion of participants (60%) as breaching at least one BCAP Code guideline breach. Overall, 83 per cent of the 350 total advertisements assessed were rated by the expert sample as breaching at least one BCAP Code guideline. See Table 3 for the full results.

The Spearman's rank correlation coefficient between the general public's and all experts' rankings of advertisements by proportion of respondents who indicated a breach in the BCAP Code was $r=0.88$ ($p=0.01$) across the seven different alcohol advertisements. The agreement of rankings of advertisements between the general public and the alcohol treatment/public health expert group was $r=0.86$ ($p=0.014$). The agreement of rankings of advertisements by the general public and the marketing expert group was $r=0.73$ ($p=0.061$).

Comparison between guidelines

The proportion of the expert sample that rated at least one advertisement as breaching a BCAP guideline was significantly different ($p<0.05$) from zero for 14 of the 15 guidelines, with guideline 19.9 not significant (see Table 4). The BCAP guideline rated as the most breached was guideline 19.8 (57% of advertisements were rated as breaching this guideline), which states that the advertisements should not imply that alcohol has therapeutic qualities capable of changing mood, physical condition or behaviour. The BCAP guideline of 19.3, which states that alcohol should not imply it can contribute to popularity and confidence, was rated as the second most breached (55% of advertisements). The guideline least rated as breached was guideline 19.9 (1% of advertisements), stating that alcohol must not be linked to illicit drugs.

The association between general public rankings compared to both groups of experts across the guidelines was $r=0.98$ ($p<0.001$).

Explaining variation in respondents' ratings of breaches

Participants from an alcohol treatment/public health background rated a higher mean number of breaches for all seven advertisements than did participants from a marketing background (Wilcoxon $W=0$, $n=7$, $p<0.05$) or the general public sample (Wilcoxon $W=0$, $n=7$, $p<0.05$). There was no significant difference in mean number of breaches across advertisements between participants from a marketing background and the general public sample (Wilcoxon $W=3$, $n=7$, $p>0.05$).

Captain Morgan's Spiced was the only advertisement where the rated number of breaches was significantly associated with appeal ratings. Higher appeal ratings for this advertisement were associated with fewer rated breaches ($r=-0.43$, $p=0.002$). There was no significant association between rated BCAP Code breaches and ratings of advertisements'

Table 1. Demographic features of sample including their professional experience.

	All experts	Marketing	Alcohol treatment/ public health
Gender			
Male	22	7	15
Female	28	18	10
Age			
18–29	6	3	3
30–44	23	15	8
45–59	16	6	10
60–74	4	1	3
Ethnicity			
White	44	20	24
Mixed/multiple ethnic groups	2	2	0
Asian/Asian British	3	2	1
Other ethnic group	1	1	0
Amount of experience (year)			
<1	3	0	3
1–5	14	7	7
6–10	9	6	3
>10	24	12	12
Main organisation work for			
University/higher education	38	25	13
City council/local government	10	0	10
Health or social care service	0	0	0
Other	2	0	2
Proportion of work concerned with alcohol (%)			
0–20	38	25	13
21–40	7	0	7
41–60	1	0	1
61–80	2	0	2
81–100	2	0	2

Missing age data for one participant.

appeal for any of the other six advertisements ($-0.01 < r < 0.21$; $0.143 < p < 0.929$). See Table 5 for the expert groups' ratings of appeal for each of the seven alcohol advertisements.

Discussion

Principal findings

Overall, 96 per cent of the experts rated one of the seven advertisements as breaching at least one alcohol-specific BCAP Code guideline, with 83 per cent of assessments of advertisements

rated by experts as breaching at least one guideline from the BCAP Code. There was a positive association between this study's combined marketing and alcohol treatment/public health expert ratings and the Searle et al. (2014) general public ratings. There was a high degree of agreement between experts' and general public's perception of the BCAP Code guideline breaches, such that the Captain Morgan's Spiced advertisement was rated as being in breach of guidelines most often and the Disaronno Originale least often. The BCAP Code guidelines that advertisements should not imply alcohol can contribute to

Table 2. Description of participants' typical alcohol consumption.

	All experts
Consume alcohol	
Yes	45
No	5
Frequency of alcoholic drink	
Almost every day	3
3–6 days a week	18
Once or twice a week to once or twice a month	21
Once every couple of months to once or twice a year	3
Not at all in last 12 months	0
Frequency of 5 or more (if male) or 4 or more (if female) alcoholic drinks in two hour period	
Almost every day	0
3–6 days a week	3
Once or twice a week to once or twice a month	7
Once every couple of months to once or twice a year	25
Not at all in last 12 months	10

popularity and confidence (19.3) or that it has therapeutic qualities (19.8) were rated by both groups as being the most frequently breached. The guideline that alcohol must not be linked to illicit drugs (19.9) was rated as least frequently breached by both groups. Experts who work in alcohol treatment/public health were more inclined to perceive a breach of a BCAP Code guideline than those who worked in marketing or the general public.

Strengths and limitations

This study's main strength is that it is the first study in the United Kingdom to investigate the extent of agreement to which expert groups and a general public sample rate television alcohol advertisements as complying with the BCAP Code. By using the same advertisements and the same questionnaire, the breaches identified by experts are comparable to those of the earlier study with the general public and thereby validates the questionnaire used.

Unlike the Searle et al. (2014) study where the 373 members of the general public viewed and completed a questionnaire on one advertisement, only 50 experts participated in this study. However, in the Searle et al. (2014) study, each participant viewed only one advertisement,

whereas participants in this study viewed all seven advertisements, resulting in a similar overall number of ratings. Furthermore, the use of a Latin square design ensured that the ordering of the advertisements was balanced across participants.

Another potential limitation of this study concerns how 'expert' the participants were, given that 17 of the 50 experts had less than 5 years' experience in their profession, and 38 were employed in universities. On the other hand, 24 of the 50 experts had over 10 years' experience, and 12 out of 25 of the alcohol treatment/public health group worked outside of universities. Degree of expertise does not appear to be a major threat to the validity of this study, given the striking degree of consensus across participants, with 48 of the 50 participants viewing at least one advertisement as breaching guidelines.

Relation to wider literature

This study's findings are consistent with previous research conducted in the United States, Australia and the United Kingdom, which found that the majority of participants rate breaches in the countries' self-regulatory guidelines concerning alcohol advertisements (Babor et al., 2013b; Jones and Donovan, 2002; Searle

Table 3. Proportion of general public and experts who perceived at least one breach of a BCAP Code guideline for each of the seven alcohol advertisements.

Advertisement	Experts (%)	Marketing (%)	Public health (%)	General public (%)
Captain Morgan's Spiced	94	96	92	91
Cobra Beer	88	92	84	77
Disaronno Originale	60	64	56	49
Foster's Lager	92	92	92	87
Guinness	78	76	80	78
Kronenbourg 1664	92	92	92	84
Strongbow Pear	80	80	80	58

The findings for the general public sample were previously reported in the Searle et al.'s (2014) study.

et al., 2014). The finding that 83 per cent of assessments of advertisements were rated by experts to breach at least one BCAP Code guideline is in opposition to the ASA's most recent survey which presented a rate of 99 per cent compliance (Advertising Standards Authority (ASA), 2010). The validity of the ASA's findings is however questionable, since the study was not conducted by an independent body, does not report details of methods used and has not been published in a peer-reviewed journal.

The finding that 83 per cent of the total advertisements assessed were rated as non-compliant with the BCAP Code is slightly higher than the Searle et al. (2014) finding that 75 per cent of the advertisements assessed by the general public sample rated a breach of at least one BCAP Code guideline. Furthermore, in this study there was a higher mean number of breaches rated by the alcohol treatment/public health group, compared with the general public or marketing groups. These findings therefore contrast somewhat with previous findings that experts rated fewer breaches than the general public (Babor et al., 2013a). However, Babor et al. (2013a) compared the community raters from various vulnerable groups, that might be motivated to rate more breaches than the general public sample in this study. Furthermore, the Babor et al. (2013a) study included a wider variety of experts, including but not limited to the alcohol treatment/public health experts in this study that rated more breaches than did the marketing experts.

The finding that only the participants' rating of appeal for the Captain Morgan's Spiced advertisement was associated with the ratings of breaches, suggests that the appeal of the advertisement has little effect on an individual's ratings of breaches of the BCAP Code. However, the results are not conclusive due to the study's small sample size.

Implications for practice

The finding that the general public and experts are in high agreement suggests that the general public can give valid judgements with regards to the BCAP Code using the Searle et al.'s (2014) questionnaire. Overall, 83 per cent of the total advertisements assessed by the expert sample were rated as breaching at least one BCAP guideline, while 75 per cent of advertisements were rated by general public as breaching a guideline. It is clear from these findings that the current self-regulatory guidelines for the United Kingdom are ineffective at regulating the content of alcohol advertisements. It has previously been argued that the current regulatory system allows advertising companies to deviate from the explicit wording of the guidelines by creating implicit campaigns that still allude to themes such as social success and underage drinking (Hastings et al., 2010). These results suggest that the general public, marketing experts and alcohol treatment/public health experts have no trouble discerning the presence of the implicit messages, although the ASA appears unable to do this.

Table 4. Proportion of breaches indicated by the general public and experts across the 15 BCAP Code guidelines.

Guideline	Experts (%)	Marketing (%)	Public health (%)	General public (%)	Statistical information for overall expert sample		
					p-value	CI lower (%)	CI upper (%)
19.2 Must not feature, encourage irresponsible or immoderate drinking	22	17	27	25	<0.001	18	26
19.3 Must neither imply that alcohol can contribute to popularity or confidence nor imply	55	54	57	52	<0.001	50	60
19.4 Must not imply that drinking alcohol is a key component of social success or acceptance and that refusal is a sign of weakness	49	43	56	46	<0.001	44	54
19.5 Must not link alcohol aggression or unruly, irresponsible or antisocial behaviour	35	29	41	35	<0.001	30	40
19.6 Must not link alcohol with sexual activity, sexual success or seduction or imply that alcohol can enhance attractiveness	41	35	48	31	<0.001	36	46
19.7 Must not portray alcohol as indispensable or taking priority in life ... can overcome problems that regular solitary drinking is acceptable	53	46	60	39	<0.001	48	58
19.8 Must not imply alcohol has therapeutic qualities capable of changing mood, physical condition or behaviour or as nourishment	57	53	62	51	<0.001	52	62
19.9 Must not link alcohol to illicit drugs	1	1	1	1	0.159	0	2
19.10 Must not imply that a drink may be preferred because of its alcohol content or or intoxicating effect	10	5	15	14	<0.001	7	13
19.12 Must not feature alcohol being handled or served irresponsibly	7	3	11	6	<0.001	4	10
19.13 Must not link alcohol with potentially dangerous machinery or driving	20	13	27	19	<0.001	16	24
19.14 Must not show alcohol being drunk by anyone in their working environment	13	9	18	13	<0.001	9	17
19.15.1 Must not appeal to people under the age 18 ... reflecting or associated with youth or showing adolescent or juvenile behaviour	22	21	23	29	<0.001	18	26
19.17 Must not feature in significant role anyone who appears under 25	14	15	13	13	<0.001	10	18
19.18 Must not make health claims	3	1	6	4	0.002	1	5

Table 5. The combined expert groups' ratings of appeal for each of the seven alcohol television advertisements.

Advertisement	<i>M</i>	<i>SD</i>
Captain Morgan's Spiced	14.34	3.81
Cobra Beer	15.07	2.15
Disaronno Originale	12.14	3.00
Foster's Lager	14.43	2.60
Guinness	14.83	3.35
Kronenbourg 1664	16.20	3.38
Strongbow Pear	13.70	3.25

SD: standard deviation.

The use of self-regulatory bodies is further questioned by research into the guidelines for Australia, where the Australian Advertising Standards Board (ASB) deals with complaints and breaches. Jones and Donovan (2002) previously found that a board of eight marketing academics rated seven out of nine alcohol advertisements, previously assessed by the ASB to be compliant, to breach at least one guideline. These results suggest that either self-regulatory bodies lack objectivity when considering the guidelines or that both groups have different interpretations of the guidelines.

There is a new compelling case for changing this system in the United Kingdom in the best interest of the public, especially given the association between higher rates of hazardous drinking and weak alcohol advertisement restrictions (Bosque Prous et al., 2014). The results of this study and other research in this area further demonstrate the need for an independent panel for reviewing BCAP Code violations.

Future research

Subsequent research into new media, such as Facebook and Twitter, also appears warranted, given that alcohol brands are starting to invest heavily in marketing via these websites. Social media provides an important communication channel for alcohol companies to present their product in a positive way (Burton et al., 2013).

These media are difficult to regulate, with the ASA (2013) previously reporting that 42 per cent of children in their survey were falsely registered as aged 18 or over on social media sites, exposing them to advertisements for age-restricted products such as alcohol.

Alcohol advertisements' non-compliance of self-regulatory guidelines has been documented across multiple countries, with a review by Noel et al. (2017) finding that none of the 19 studies analysed concluded that the guidelines were effective. As the ASA appears to be the main group perceiving alcohol advertisements as highly compliant with the BCAP Code, it is important that their decision-making process be investigated in order to analyse how they arrive at their judgments. This could be carried out by analysing the ASA's documents on dealing with complaints of breaches of the BCAP Code, similar to the way Hastings et al. (2010) analysed a large number of internal marketing documents from alcohol producers and their communications agencies.

In addition, further research into the effect of advertisement appeal on the ratings of BCAP Code breaches is warranted, using a larger sample of both participants and alcohol advertisements. It would add most to knowledge if the alcohol advertisements tested were award winning or exemplary in some other way to further examine the effects of the advertisement's appeal on ratings of BCAP guideline breaches. Further examination of the ratings of different occupation groups also appears warranted, given the discrepancy in results between UK and US studies on the association of occupational group and number of breaches.

Summary

The vast majority of experts rated at least one breach of a BCAP Code guideline in the seven alcohol advertisements. These findings make it clear that the current UK self-regulatory guidelines for alcohol advertisements are ineffective at protecting the public. The results are

consistent with a number of international studies, which indicates that there is a problem not just with the BCAP Code but with the general use of self-regulatory alcohol guidelines. The case is now compelling for an independent review panel to regulate and moderate the advertisements for breaches.

Declaration of Conflicting Interests

The author(s) declared no potential conflicts of interest with respect to the research, authorship, and/or publication of this article.

Funding

The author(s) received no financial support for the research, authorship and/or publication of this article.

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Appendix I

A Latin square design was used to counterbalance the order in which the seven alcohol television advertisements were shown to the participants. A Williams (1949) design Latin square was used, as there were seven treatments/advertisements in the study, and the participants

were subjected to all treatments. See below for the experimental design table used to counterbalance the advertisements in this study.

A	B	G	C	F	D	E
B	C	A	D	G	E	F
C	D	B	E	A	F	G
D	E	C	F	B	G	A
E	F	D	G	C	A	B
F	G	E	A	D	B	C
G	A	F	B	E	C	D
E	D	F	C	G	B	A
F	E	G	D	A	C	B
G	F	A	E	B	D	C
A	G	B	F	C	E	D
B	A	C	G	D	F	E
C	B	D	A	E	G	F
D	C	E	B	F	A	G